CHESS MANIA!

Game Manual

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1. WHAT IS CHESS MANIA!?

Chess has been played by people all over the world for hundreds, if not thousands of years. It certainly has seen some changes in gameplay and rules, but the essence of chess has always stayed the same: a board game for two players.

CHESS MANIA! changes that completely by allowing four players to play on the same board. The game board has 160 squares and each player has a different color for their set of pieces, namely red, blue, yellow and green. But that's not all.

CHESS MANIA! is a team game. The teams are composed of two players each, who are always across the board from each other. Since this is a team game, working together is very important.

The rules for regular chess mostly apply to this game, but some changes have been made to make the game exhilarating and much faster than regular chess games:

Unlike normal chess, the main goal of CHESS MANIA! is not to checkmate one member of the opposing team. The main goal is to capture as many opponent pieces as possible. Each piece is worth a certain amount of points, with the king being the most valuable and the more pieces you capture, the more points you get.

Each game has a time limit of 5 minutes. After the time is over, the team with the most points wins the game. But the time limit is not the only thing that can end the game. Once a king is captured the game ends immediately and the team with the most points wins.

And to make CHESS MANIA! even crazier, each player has 10 seconds to make a move. If you're not fast enough, you will be skipped and the next player in line can make their move.

With all these different and refreshing rules, CHESS MANIA! hopes to give a new chess experience to everybody.

*CHESS MANIA! is still in development. This version does not represent the final product. At this moment the main functionalities of the game and the rules are already programmed and the game can be fully played on the console.

2. RULES

As it was already stated before, CHESS MANIA! is a team game. Each team consists of two players and each player has a different color for their set of pieces. Red and yellow make up the first team and blue and green the second team. The team players are always across the board from each other. Also important to know is that the game always starts with Red and follows in clockwise order.

The Chessboard consists of 160 squares that can be empty or occupied by the player's pieces. Each player starts with a set of 16 pieces, consisting of 8 pawns, 2 rooks, 2 knights, 2 bishops, a queen and a king, all in the same color.

A 5 minute timer will begin to count down after initiating the game. During that time, the players are able to play the game and move their pieces when it's their turn. Players also have a time limit of 10 seconds for their turn. If a player doesn't make a move during this period, they will be skipped and it will be the next player's turn to make a move.

The main goal of CHESS MANIA! is to capture as many opponent pieces as possible and have the most points at the end of the game. The players get points by capturing their opponents pieces. Important to know is that players cannot capture their teammates' pieces.

This table shows the amount of points that every piece is worth:

Pawn	Promoted Pawn (Fake Queen)	Knight	Rook	Bishop	Queen	King
1 Point	1 Points	3 Points	5 Points	5 Points	9 Points	20 Points

The traditional checkmate was replaced by the capture of the king. Since the king is worth an incredible amount of points it's important to defend it at any cost. The game ends after a king piece is captured by a player or if the 5 minute game timer runs out. Then the team with the most points wins.

Every move has to follow the rules of the chess pieces as listed in the next chapter. And the players can only make a piece move, if it doesn’t put or leave the player's king in a “check” position. It is possible that a player can't make any valid moves without breaking this rule. In that case the player's move will be skipped and unless his teammate manages to get him out of “check” his king likely will be captured by one of the opponents, resulting in the end of the game.

3. BASIC MOVES

Most of the rules and moves of regular chess still apply to CHESS MANIA!

The Pawns
Pawns are very simple in their movement. Each player begins a game with 8 pawns, standing in front of their other chess pieces.

- Pawns can only move forward one square.
- Pawns can move forward two squares on their first move only.
- Pawns can move diagonally forward when capturing an opponent's chess piece.
- A pawn automatically promotes to a queen, once it moves 6 squares forward (passes over half the board).

The Rook
Rooks are the most simple chess pieces to move.

- Rooks can move forward, backward, left, or right at any given time.
- Rooks can move in any direction, as long as it is not being hindered by any other pieces.

The Knight
Knights move very differently from the other pieces. They are also the only piece capable of jumping over other pieces.

- Knights can move two squares in any direction vertically followed by one square horizontally.
- Knights can move two squares in any direction horizontally followed by one square vertically.
- Knights can only move to one of up to eight positions on the board.
- Knights can move to any position that is not already occupied by another piece of its player or teammate.
- Knights can skip over any piece to reach their desired position.

The Bishop
Bishops can move diagonally. Each player starts out with two bishops and can cover the whole board with them.

- Bishops can move in any direction diagonally, as long as there is no other piece in their way.
- Bishops cannot move past any piece that is blocking their way.
- Bishops can capture any opponent piece on the board that is within their range of movement.

The Queen

The Queen is not only considered the most versatile chess piece on the board, but also the most dangerous. The queen is like a combination of the Rook and Bishop. Each player starts out with one queen piece but any pawn can promote and turn into a queen too.

- The queen can move in any direction on a straight or diagonal path.
- The queen cannot move past any piece that is blocking her way.
- The queen's movements are restricted to any direction of unoccupied squares.

The King

The king is in comparison with the other pieces somewhat limited in his movement.

- The king can move one single square in any direction.
- The king cannot move on to a square that is occupied by a piece of the same color/team.
- The king cannot move to any square that puts him into a “check” position.
- Once the king is captured the game is over.

4. HOW TO PLAY

The game is currently played on the console.

To play the game you have to first start the server by typing
`java -jar ChessMania-0.1.0.jar server 4657`
into the console and press Enter.

After starting the server, you can start the client by typing
`java -jar ChessMania-0.1.0.jar client <hostadress>:4657 [<username>]`
into the console and press Enter.

Make sure that you are in the same directory as the .jar file. Also make sure to replace `<hostadress>` with the IP-Address of the host or write `localhost` if you are running the server locally on your device. You can also already insert your username at the end of the command, but it is not mandatory.

If you don't insert your username at the end of the command, you will be asked to type in your username. Once you have entered your username on the console you can start to chat with all the others who have also entered the chat, by simply typing a message.

Here is an overview of all the possible commands. You can also type “COMMANDS” at any time to get a look at them:

SETNAME	This allows you to change your username.
SHOWNAME	This shows you your current username.
WHISPER <playername> <message>*	This allows you to send private messages to a specific player.
@<playername> <message>*	This is an alternative command that also allows you to send private messages to specific players.
SHOWPLAYERS	This gives you a list of all the players that are online.
NEWLOBBY	This command creates a new lobby.
JOINLOBBY <lobbyID>*	This adds you to the lobby that has the corresponding lobbyID.
SHOWLOBBY	This shows you the lobby you are currently in.
SHOWLOBBIES	This gives you a list of all the created lobbies and their

	players.
@lobby <message>*	This allows you to send messages to all the players in the lobby.
QUITLOBBY	This command removes you from your lobby.
SHOWGAMES	This command shows you a list of all games that are currently being played.
PASTGAMES	This command shows you a list of all finished games.
OPENGAMES	This command shows you a list of all open games that you can join.
LOGOUT	This closes the chat and the game in general.
NEWGAME	This command starts a new game, once the lobby is full.
RTT	This command shows you your round-trip time
COMMANDS	This gives you a list of all the commands.
MOVE <startSquare/endSquare>	This allows you to make a move during the game.

* The angle brackets are just for visualisation in the table and are not needed.

You can choose to create a new lobby or to join an already existing one by either typing “NEWLOBBY” or “JOINLOBBY <lobbyID>”. You will have to wait until the lobby is full before starting a new game. Once the lobby has 4 players, you can start a new game by simply typing “NEWGAME”.

Once started, each player will be able to see the 14 x 14 chessboard on the console with all the chess pieces placed on top. The chess pieces are represented by letters and symbols like for example R-P. The first letter stands for the color of that piece, in this case red. The symbol in the middle helps to identify the pieces more easily and the last letter stands for the type of piece, in this case pawn.

R-...	B*...	Y+...	G: ...	...P	...R	...N	...B	...Q	...K
Red	Blue	Yellow	Green	Pawn	Rook	Knight	Bishop	Queen	King

Each square of the chessboard is identified by an unique coordinate pair as for example G4, H5 or B2. During one’s own turn, one can send a move as for example G2/G4. The first coordinate represents the piece that is to be moved, while the second coordinate represents the square one wants to move the piece to. It is

important to separate both coordinates with a backslash in order for the move to be recognized. To transmit the move you have to type “MOVE” followed by the coordinates as explained above.

After making a move, the next player is able to make their own move and so on. If you don't make your move within 10 seconds you are skipped and it's the next player's turn to make a move. The game ends when one player's king piece gets captured by its opponents or if the 5 minute timer runs out. The result and the winning team is displayed on the console.

You can communicate with your teammate by using the commands listed above in the table. Also good to know is that the commands don't need to be written in upper-case.

HAVE FUN AND STAY SANE, CHESS MANIAC!